

Assignment: Target Company Research

DeepThought – Business Analytics Internship

City Chosen: Bengaluru

Segment: Defence Electronics, Aerospace & Precision Engineering
Manufacturing

Date: 2026

Methodology

Introduction

For this assignment, I selected Bengaluru as the target city and focused primarily on Defence Electronics, Aerospace Systems, Industrial Sensors, and Advanced Engineering Manufacturing companies. These industries align closely with DeepThought's Federer profile because they involve technical products, significant operational infrastructure, R&D investment, and longterm growth opportunities.

The objective was to identify companies that are producer-led, operationally mature, and actively investing in growth rather than simply acting as traders or distributors.

Why I Chose Bengaluru

Bengaluru is one of India's strongest hubs for aerospace, defence, electronics, and advanced manufacturing. The city has a large concentration of organizations working with ISRO, DRDO, HAL, BEL, and private defence programs.

It also offers a strong ecosystem of engineering talent, R&D centres, industrial parks, and manufacturing facilities. Because of this concentration, Bengaluru provides a higher probability of finding companies that match DeepThought's ideal customer profile.

Why I Chose This Segment

I focused on defence electronics, aerospace systems, industrial automation, embedded systems, and precision engineering manufacturers.

These sectors demonstrate several characteristics of a Federer company:

- Technical and differentiated products
- High entry barriers
- Strong engineering teams
- Government and defence sector tailwinds
- Investments in quality systems and certifications
- Long-term capability building rather than outsourcing

Many companies in these sectors also show evidence of structured operations, professional leadership teams, and expansion initiatives.

Research Sources Used

To identify and evaluate companies, I used multiple sources rather than relying on a single database.

The primary sources included:

- Company websites

- LinkedIn company profiles
- Tracxn
- Tofler
- MCA filings
- Annual reports
- Press releases and news articles
- Aero India exhibitor directories
- Invest Karnataka resources
- Defence industry publications
- Company career pages and job postings

Using multiple sources helped validate information and reduce the risk of incorrect classification.

Research Process

The research process followed a structured funnel approach.

Step 1: Build an initial list of companies operating in Bengaluru within the selected sectors.

Step 2: Verify whether the company passes the E1 Producer criterion by checking whether it manufactures products, develops technology, owns facilities, or delivers specialized solutions through its own infrastructure.

Step 3: Verify the E2 Accessible criterion by confirming operational presence in India and active business operations.

Step 4: Research the leadership team and identify decision-makers such as founders, managing directors, CEOs, or executive directors.

Step 5: Evaluate each company against the six Federer criteria (C3-C8) using publicly available evidence.

Step 6: Assign scores based on the strength of evidence and calculate the overall Federer Score.

Step 7: Develop a personalization hook using a specific company achievement, product launch, certification, expansion announcement, partnership, or industry milestone.

Scoring Approach

The Federer scoring framework was used to assess company quality.

Each company was evaluated across:

- Differentiation (C3)
- Decision-Maker Quality (C4)

- Growing Sector (C5)
- Growth Signals (C6)
- Systems Maturity (C7)
- Leadership Succession (C8)

Scores were assigned as Weak, Moderate, or Strong based on available evidence.

Companies with higher evidence of technical differentiation, operational maturity, leadership depth, and growth activity received higher scores.

The final Federer Score was used to classify companies into A, B, C, or D bands.

Challenges Faced

Several challenges were encountered during the research process.

- Revenue information was not publicly available for all private companies.
- Leadership backgrounds were sometimes difficult to verify.
- ERP, SAP, and internal systems information was often not explicitly disclosed.
- Some companies appeared to be manufacturers initially but were actually distributors or service providers.
- Different data sources occasionally reported conflicting information which required additional verification.

To address these issues, information was cross-checked using multiple sources whenever possible.

Key Learnings

This assignment provided valuable exposure to company research and qualification.

Some important learnings were:

- Technical differentiation alone does not guarantee a strong Federer score.
- Leadership quality and systems maturity are often stronger indicators of long-term potential.
- Many companies with good products lack evidence of structured operational systems.
- Growth signals such as hiring, certifications, and facility expansion are useful indicators of business momentum.
- Combining multiple data sources produces more reliable company profiles than relying on a single platform.

Overall, the assignment helped develop a structured approach to identifying high-potential companies that fit DeepThought's ideal customer profile.